

Dubai Customs Transition from 8-digit to 12-digit HS Code

- Adoption of Integrated Customs Tariff Nomenclature -

HS CODE



Agenda

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Introduction to Transition

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Preparing Stakeholders – Tools, Resources & Facilitations

What is HS Code?

Harmonized System that is used to classify goods and determine customs procedures & duty rates. Previously, items consisted of 8-Digit HS codes and are updated by adding 4 numbers to convert to 12-Digit HS codes.

Integrated Customs Tariff Includes:

- **Customs HS codes**
- **Customs duty rate**
- **Free Trade Agreements**
- **Anti-Dumping rate**
- **Value Added Tax & Excise Tax**
- **Local & Federal Restriction and Prohibition Controlling Authorities**



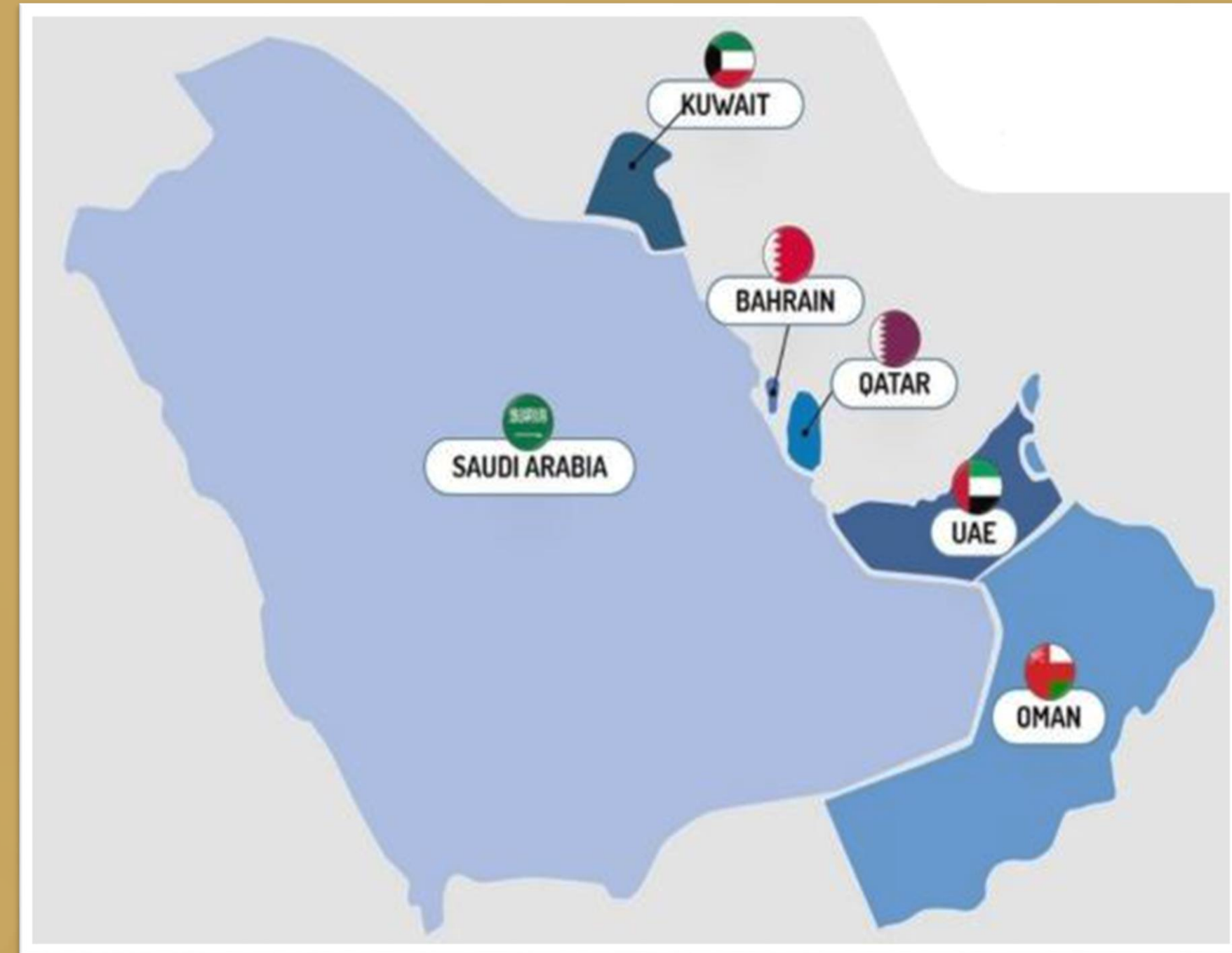
Integrated Customs Tariff

Reasons for Transitions

GCC has published the Tariff Integrated Schedule based on Harmonized Commodity Description and Coding System of the WCO (2022), updating the GCC HS Codes from 8-digits to 12-digits

Based on Cabinet Resolution No. (119) of 2024 in regards to approval of the integrated customs tariff nomenclature based on Harmonized Commodity Description and Coding System of the GCC states.

Starting August 2025, a new 12-digit harmonized system will be implemented to enhance accuracy, reduce potential discrepancies, and promote standardization of customs procedures.



Benefits of Transition to GCC HS Code

While challenges such as misidentification, classification errors, and increased complexity are anticipated, the benefits of alignment with the GCC mandate make this transition essential.

1



Standardize customs processes across the GCC to enable policy-level alignment

2



Support stakeholders in adapting to the GCC-wide 12-digit system for smoother cross-border operations.

This is why the implementation is being carried out in a phased, transitional manner, to minimize disruptions and support gradual adaptation.

Trade Flows **Exempted** from 12-Digit HS Codes

(**exempted** from application of integrated customs tariff)

12

Declaration types **included** in
12-Digit classification



GCC Trade



Imports to Mainland



Temporary Flows

8

Declaration types **exempted** from
12-Digit classification



***Free Zone Transit IN/OUT to Other than
GCC/between Dubai Free Zones***



Transshipments



Transit Trade



Transfer within Free Zones



Local Exports to Rest of World

For exempted trade flows, 8-digit codes continue to apply

Why are these exceptions created?

1



Allow operational flexibility
during the initial transition phase

2



Avoid complicated procedures
and transit delays

3



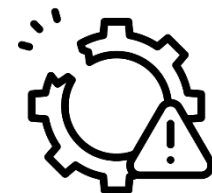
Reduce administration and
financial burdens on traders

4



Safeguard International Trade &
Maintain Dubai's position as a
leading global logistics hub

5



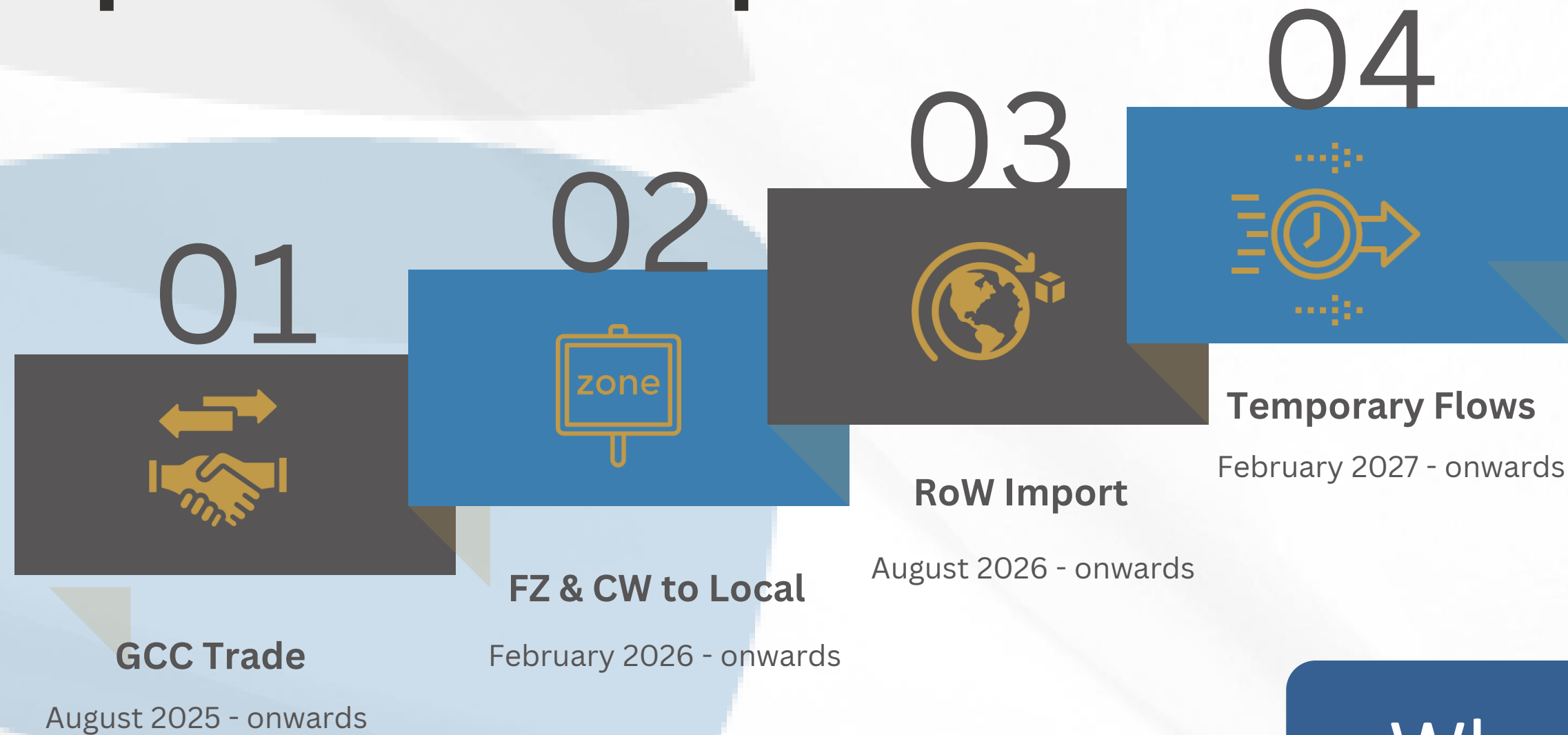
Ensure minimal disruption to
international trade flows

6



Not targeting local market

Implementation phases



Why a phased approach?

Gradual, low-risk application

Strategic plan to allow gradual implementation based on type of trade in order to reduce disruptions, facilitate implementation, monitor the impacts and enable direct improvements.

A B C

0102.03

**What does this mean to
you?**

Items at 12-digit HS code level

From 7809 to 13450 HS codes



Newly Inserted HS codes

New codes added to
cover items that were not
previously classified

951

HS Codes



Sub-Divided HS codes

Expand an existing section to
include specific products in
precise process

6518

HS Codes



Unchanged HS codes

Zeros added with no
modification to the
content

5981

HS Codes



Unchanged HS codes

Smart phone devices

85171300

85171300 0000

Zeros added to comply with 12-digit integrated customs
tariff nomenclature

Unchanged HS codes

Sunglasses

90041000

90041000 0000

Zeros added to comply with 12-digit integrated customs
tariff nomenclature



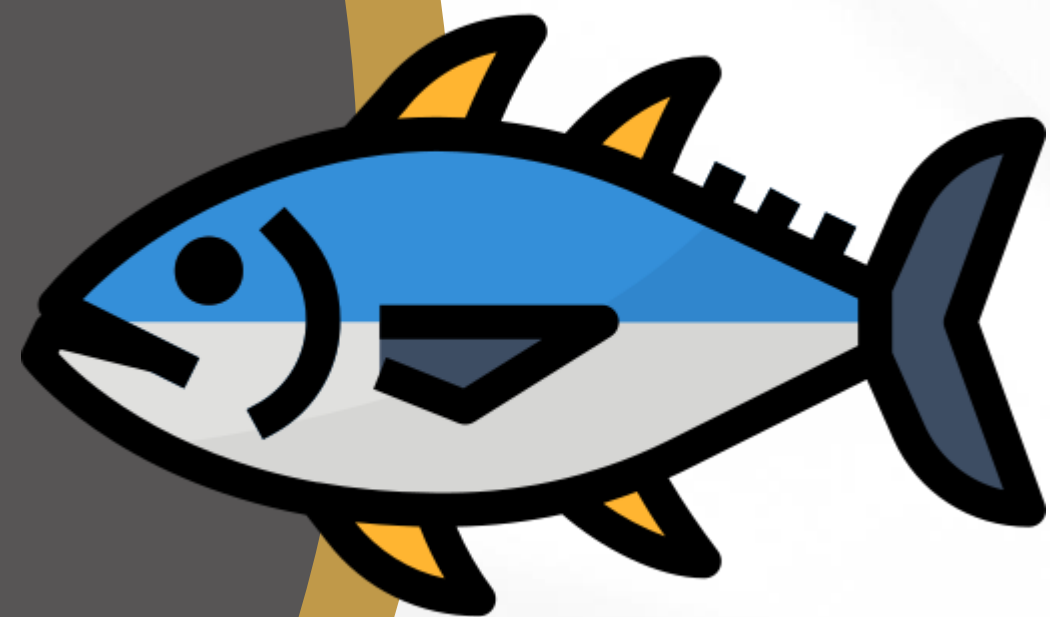
Unchanged HS codes

Igniters

36035000

36035000 0000

Zeros added to comply with 12-digit integrated customs
tariff nomenclature



Unchanged HS codes

Big Eye Tunas

03023400

03023400 0000

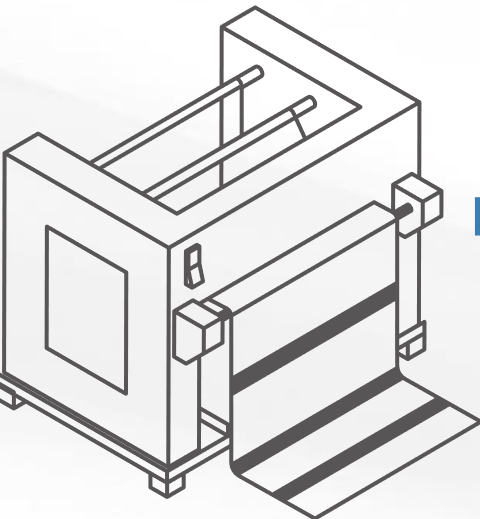
Zeros added to comply with 12-digit integrated customs
tariff nomenclature

Sub-headings

84 20 10 00



Calendaring or other rolling machines, other than for metals or glass



1

84201000 0001
Paper Polishing Machines

2

84201000 0002
Textile Polishing Machines

3

84201000 0003
Leather Polishing Machines

4

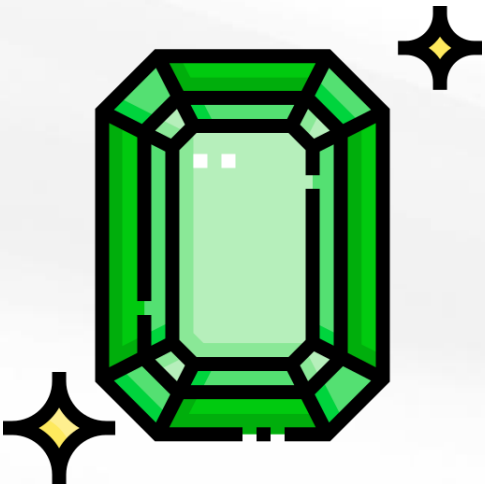
84201000 0004
Plastic Polishing Machines

Sub-headings



71 03 91 00

Rubies, sapphires and emeralds



1

71 03 91 00 00 01
Rubies

2

71 03 91 00 00 02
Sapphires

3

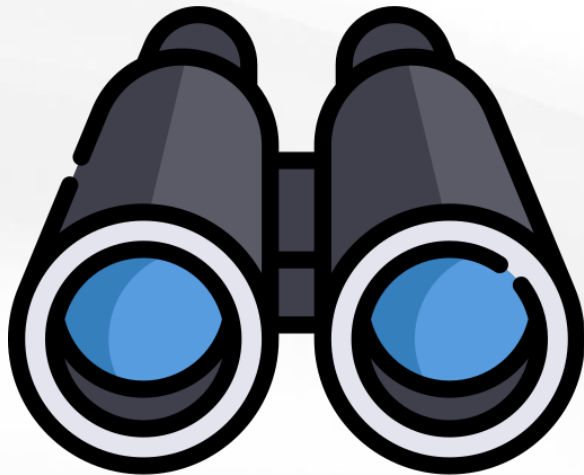
71 03 91 00 00 03
Emeralds

Sub-headings



90 05 10 00

Binoculars



1

90 05 10 00 00 01

Night Vision Binoculars

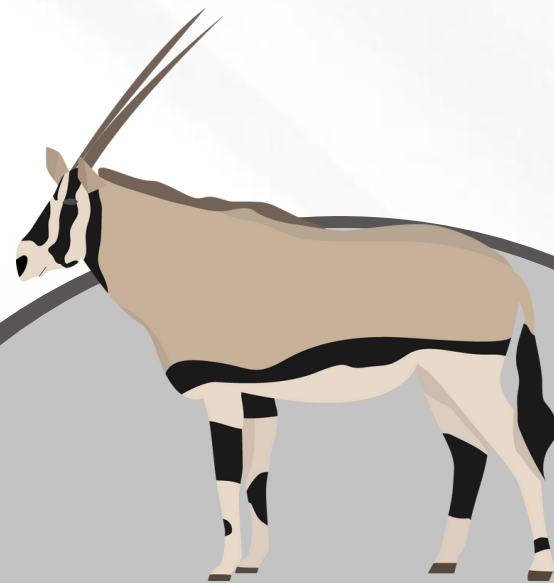
2

90 05 10 00 00 02

Other Binoculars

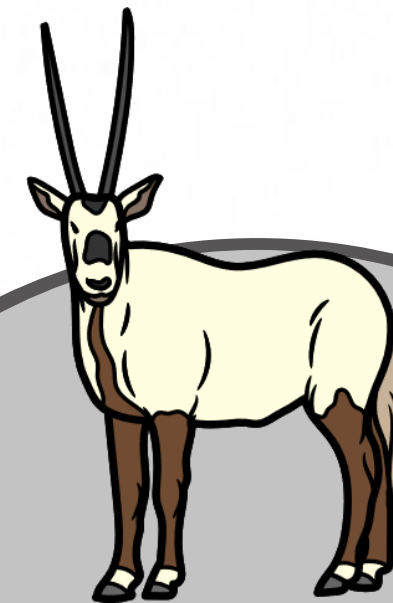
NEWLY Inserted HS Codes

Oryx



Live African Oryx

01029012 0000



Live Arabian Oryx

01029011 0000

Dubai Customs' Preparations

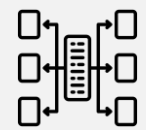


Tools & Resources



AI Munassiq:

AI Built IN Application HS code classification



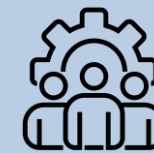
Correlation Table:

8-to-12-digit code mapping



Trader Guidebook:

Transition reference guide with FAQs



Operational Support



Extended Operating Hours & Live

Support: *Available daily from 8 am to 6 pm*



Reclassification Service:

Ask Dubai Customs to provide the correct classification



Workshops:

Weekly orientation sessions for traders

Dubai Customs' Preparations

Tools and Resources

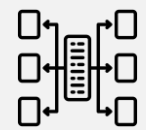


Tools & Resources



AI Munassiq:

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Dubai Customs' Preparations

Tools and Resources

Tool



AI Munassiq



Digital app providing **AI enabled classification of goods**, including:



HS Codes



Duty Rate



Restrictions



Correlation Table

Old HS Code	Description	New HS Code	Description	Old HS Code	Description	New HS Code	Description
850110	Other electric motors of 1000 W or less	850110	Other electric motors of 1000 W or less	850110	Other electric motors of 1000 W or less	850110	Other electric motors of 1000 W or less
850120	Other electric motors of more than 1000 W	850120	Other electric motors of more than 1000 W	850120	Other electric motors of more than 1000 W	850120	Other electric motors of more than 1000 W
850210	Other electric motors of 1000 W or less	850210	Other electric motors of 1000 W or less	850210	Other electric motors of 1000 W or less	850210	Other electric motors of 1000 W or less
850220	Other electric motors of more than 1000 W	850220	Other electric motors of more than 1000 W	850220	Other electric motors of more than 1000 W	850220	Other electric motors of more than 1000 W

Table mapping the old HS codes to the new 12-digit codes, including:



Units of measurement



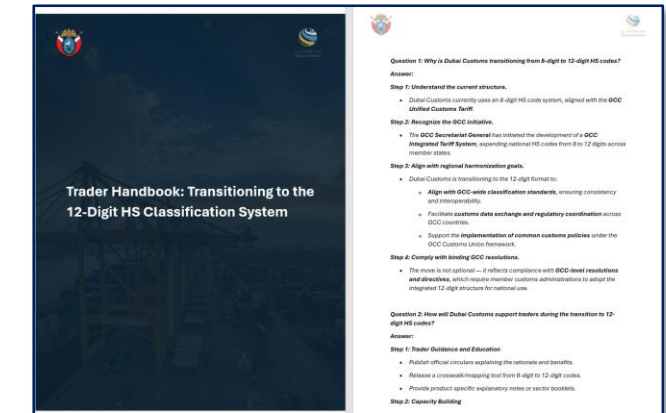
Customs Duty Rate



Required permits (if applicable)



Trader Guidebook



Manual guiding traders through key changes & steps needed for a smooth transition :



Step-by-step Declaration Guide



Key FAQs

Support Provided



Available in Apple Store, Google Play & Website



Available at DC Website



Available at DC Website



Available indefinitely

Service Channel

Duration

Dubai Customs' Preparations

Operational Support



Tools & Documentation



Al Munassiq:

Automated HS code reclassification



Conversion Table:

8-to-12-digit code mapping



Trader Handbook:

Transition reference guide with FAQs



Operational Support



Extended Operating Hours & Live

Support: *Available daily from 8am to 6pm*



Reclassification Service:

Ask Dubai Customs to provide the correct classification



Workshops:

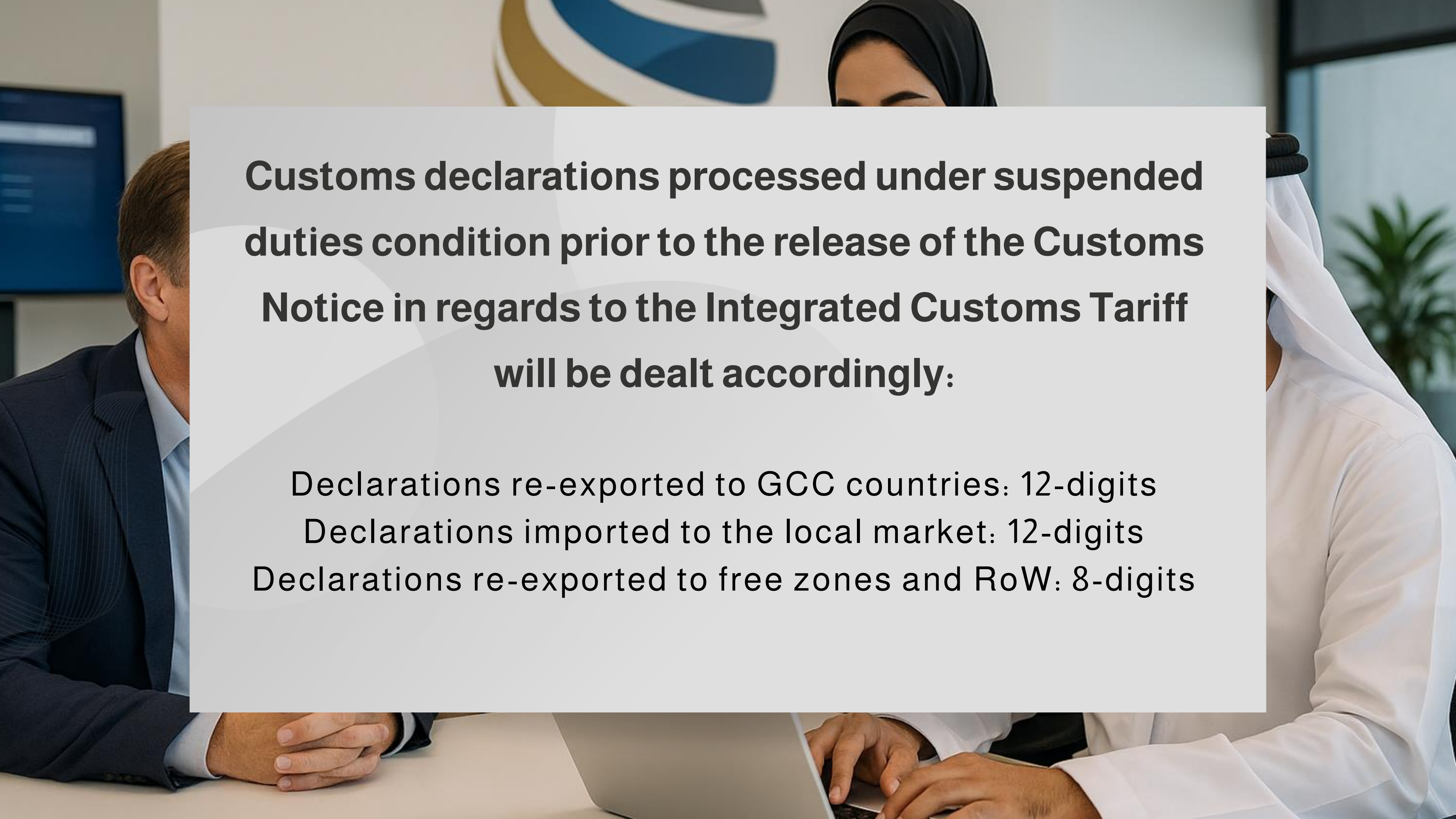
Weekly orientation sessions for traders

Dubai Customs' Preparations

Operational Support

			
Tool	Extended Operating Hours	Reclassification Service	Workshops
Support Provided	<i>Live support for traders regarding all questions related to the 12-digit classification service by the Tariff department daily between 8am – 6pm</i>	<i>Submit goods descriptions and receive a Dubai Customs verified classification within 1 working day</i>	<i>Attend weekly workshops to learn more about the transition and available tools for your support</i>
Service Channel	 Phone: 8001886	 Dubai Customs Online Services	• Microsoft Teams • Dubai Logistics Academy
Duration	<i>Extended hours available until year end</i>	 Available Indefinitely	<i>weekly sessions</i>



A background image showing a business meeting. On the left, a man in a dark blue suit is seated at a desk. On the right, a woman wearing a black hijab and a white thobe is standing. In the foreground, another person's hands are visible typing on a laptop. The scene is set in a modern office with a large window in the background.

Customs declarations processed under suspended duties condition prior to the release of the Customs Notice in regards to the Integrated Customs Tariff will be dealt accordingly:

Declarations re-exported to GCC countries: 12-digits
Declarations imported to the local market: 12-digits
Declarations re-exported to free zones and RoW: 8-digits

Support and Communication

- 1 Dubai Customs official page
www.dubaicustoms.ae
- 2 Online services available on Dubai Trade platform
www.dubaitrade.ae
- 3 Contact Client Happiness Department
Phone: 8001886
Email: 1886@dubaicustoms.ae
- 4 Upcoming awareness workshops to raise readiness and compliance level

Thank YOU

